*All figures sourced from Government of Canada and Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal and provincial statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.*

## Section 1.6 — The Bridge to Sixty-Five

The worker traced through this Movement is now sixty-three years old. The accident, the long-running WCB claim, the AISH application, the AISH-to-ADAP transition, the marriage breakdown, the years on a fixed inadequate income, the cohabitation rule's structural pressure to remain alone — all of it is two decades behind. The worker's surviving social network is small. Their savings are exhausted. Their physical health has deteriorated under twenty years of poverty-line existence with limited access to non-insured medical services. Their mental health has been managed at whatever level the public system has been able to deliver. They have done what was asked of them at every stage. The system has done what its rules required at every stage. The two outcomes are not the same.

This Section closes Movement One by walking the final two years before the senior system begins. It is the shortest Section of Movement One because its function is bridging — to name what is approaching, to set up the program-by-program walk that Movement Two performs, and to make explicit the lifecycle observation that the document has been building toward since Section 1.1.

### What turns over at sixty-five

At age sixty-five, several things turn over at once for the worker on AISH or ADAP:

- AISH and ADAP eligibility ends. The provincial disability income program assumes the recipient transitions to federal seniors programs and ceases provincial payment. (*Source: Government of Alberta — AISH program rules; Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Regulation, Alta Reg 91/2007; Government of Alberta — ADAP transition page, 2026.*) The recipient is no longer a disability program recipient. They are a senior.
- Old Age Security begins, if residency requirements are met. The current OAS rate (January–March 2026) for recipients aged 65–74 is seven hundred and forty-two dollars and thirty-one cents per month. (*Source: Service Canada — Old Age Security Benefit Payment Rates, January–March 2026.*)
- Canada Pension Plan retirement begins, if not already begun, at the formula amount calculated against the recipient's lifetime contribution history. The recipient's contribution history was interrupted at the time of the disability — in the worker's case, age forty-two. Twenty-three years of zero or near-zero CPP contributions reduce the retirement-pension calculation substantially. The maximum CPP retirement pension for new beneficiaries beginning in January 2026 is one thousand five hundred and seven dollars and sixty-five cents per month. (*Source: Service Canada — CPP Maximum Benefit Amounts, January 2026.*) The average new CPP retirement pension at age sixty-five for new beneficiaries (April–June 2026) is nine hundred and twenty-five dollars and thirty-five cents per month. (*Source: Service Canada — CPP Statistics, April–June 2026.*) For a recipient whose contribution history was interrupted at age forty-two, the actual retirement-pension amount is materially below the average — typically in the range of three hundred to six hundred dollars per month, depending on the contribution history before the disability and the operation of the disability dropout provision.
- Guaranteed Income Supplement eligibility begins, subject to income testing. For the worker arriving at sixty-five with no other income beyond OAS and a small CPP, GIS will be the largest single component of monthly income. The current single-recipient GIS maximum (January–March 2026) is one thousand one hundred and nine dollars and eighty-five cents per month at incomes below approximately twenty-two thousand four hundred and forty dollars per year. (*Source: Service Canada — Guaranteed Income Supplement Payment Rates, January–March 2026.*)

- For the worker who continued to receive WCB Economic Loss Payments throughout the working years, the ELP retirement adjustment described in Section 1.2 takes effect. The wage-loss benefit is recalculated at two per cent of cumulative wage-loss compensation paid from the date of accident to age sixty-five, payable for the rest of the worker's life. The adjustment typically reduces monthly WCB income by seventy to ninety per cent.

The transitions are not coordinated. The worker is responsible for applying for OAS, applying for CPP retirement, applying for GIS, and notifying Alberta Assisted Living and Social Services that they are aging out of AISH or ADAP. Each application has its own form, its own processing time, and its own potential for error or delay. There is no single transition office, no single transition application, and no single point of accountability if the transitions do not align. Recipients with cognitive disabilities, communication-related disabilities, or limited literacy navigate these transitions with limited support. Some do not complete the transitions on time and experience income gaps in the months around their sixty-fifth birthday.

### What the worker actually receives at sixty-five

For the worker traced through this Movement — interrupted CPP contributions at age forty-two, full forty-year Canadian residency for OAS, no employer pension, no significant retirement savings — the monthly income at age sixty-five is approximately as follows:

- OAS (age 65–74): seven hundred and forty-two dollars and thirty-one cents
- CPP retirement (interrupted contributions): four hundred to six hundred dollars (illustrative; actual amount depends on individual contribution history)
- GIS (income-tested at low income levels): typically eight hundred to one thousand dollars (the GIS amount declines as CPP and other income rise; for a recipient with five hundred dollars of CPP, GIS is reduced from the maximum but remains the largest single component)

Total monthly income at sixty-five, for the worker on the unfavourable side of the cascade: approximately two thousand to two thousand three hundred dollars. The 2026 Canadian after-tax Market Basket Measure poverty threshold for a single person in Edmonton is approximately twenty-five thousand to twenty-seven thousand dollars per year. (*Source: Statistics Canada — Market Basket Measure thresholds, Canadian Income Survey, 2024 and 2025 reference periods, projected to 2026.*) The worker's senior income is at or marginally above the poverty line for a single person. It is below the threshold for a couple living together. If the worker reconciles with their former spouse — for emotional support, for shared housing, for caregiving in either direction — the GIS income test reduces both partners' GIS amounts and the household total declines, in some scenarios below where it would be if the partners lived separately.

This is the partnership penalty at the senior stage. It is the same mechanism the cohabitation rule operates at the working-age stage, in a different program, with different numbers, producing the same structural pressure. The worker who finally has the option to be in a household with another person again is structurally penalized for choosing it. Movement Two walks this in detail.

### The cumulative observation

The worker has, by the age of sixty-five:

- Paid in lifetime contributions, taxes, and premiums in the range of seven hundred thousand dollars (Section 1.1)

- Received, across the disability years, a fraction of those contributions back through WCB and AISH/ADAP, with the bulk of the contribution captured by the cap structures, the asset spend-down requirements, and the dollar-for-dollar offsets of CPP-D and CDB (Sections 1.1, 1.4)
- Lost the marriage and the household and most of the social network the working years built (Section 1.5)
- Lost the retirement savings, the home equity that could not be maintained, the vehicle, the investments (Sections 1.1, 1.3)
- Arrived at sixty-five with monthly income at the poverty floor and structural pressure to remain alone (this Section)

The structural pattern has been documented at every stage. The mechanisms are published. The numbers are public. The lifecycle of capture and exclusion that the worker has traced through this Movement is not a sequence of unfortunate individual decisions or of program failures at specific points. It is the operating reality of an architecture that was built, program by program, across decades, with each program designed to deliver the minimum and to capture the maximum, and with no part of the architecture coordinated against the cumulative experience of the recipient who passes through all of them.

### What Movement One has named

This Movement has named the cascade for the working-age person whose body fails. It has walked the entry into WCB, the operational reality of WCB benefits and disputes and the age-65 cliff. It has walked the AISH application, the asset spend-down, the wait, the appeal that no longer exists. It has walked the AISH-to-ADAP transition as the next reassessment in a continuous reassessment architecture. It has walked the cohabitation rule and the family-level operational reality of the partnership penalty at the working-age stage. It has bridged to age sixty-five and named the senior system the worker is about to enter.

Movement One has been written for the working-age reader who did not believe this document was about them. It has been written so that reader can see the cascade in operational detail, in primary-source-grounded numbers, in the actual rules and programs that will be applied to them if their body fails or their work ends. The cascade is documented. The mechanisms are published. The reader who finishes Movement One has been given the cage, end to end, at the working-age stage.

Movement Two now walks the senior system the worker is about to enter. It documents Old Age Security, Canada Pension Plan, the Guaranteed Income Supplement, the Allowance, the Allowance for the Survivor, CPP Survivor Benefits, CPP credit splitting, CPP pension sharing, Alberta Seniors Benefit, Special Needs Assistance for Seniors, the Alberta Seniors Drug Benefit, and long-term care accommodation calculations. It walks the lifecycle reassessment thread that Movement One has begun to name. It walks the partnership penalty, stage by stage, with the published math. It walks the "what you put in versus what you get back" question, in eight layers, with the Service Canada figures and the Government of Alberta open data. It walks the gap inventory of what is and is not covered for seniors in this country.

The worker has reached sixty-five. The senior system begins.

The cage does not end. It changes shape.